

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: recognise several mentha varieties; identify menthol.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *pudīnā* (IAST: pudīnā; lit. “mint — *Mentha* spp.”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Mentha* genus — many species: *M. arvensis* (corn mint, *pudīnā*), *M. spicata* (spearmint), *M. piperita* (peppermint). Distinguish by leaf shape, smell.
2. **Active compound.** Menthol (peppermint), carvone (spearmint). Both terpenoids, both “cooling” perceptually (menthol activates cold-sensing TRPM8 receptors in the mouth).
3. **Traditional uses.** Less prominent in classical Caraka/Suśruta (mint was a later introduction to Indian materia medica). Modern Āyurveda uses for: cooling drinks, digestive aid, breath freshener.
4. **Modern research.** Peppermint oil — well-studied for IBS symptom relief (*BMJ*, multiple trials). Cooling sensation is a TRPM8 channel effect, NOT actual cooling of tissue.
5. **Activity.** Cooling-sensation test: students suck on a peppermint and report on tongue temperature. “*Is the mint actually cool? Or does it just feel cool?*” (It’s the TRPM8 receptor activation — the same nerve that signals real cold.)

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Mint — Cooling Leaf.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).